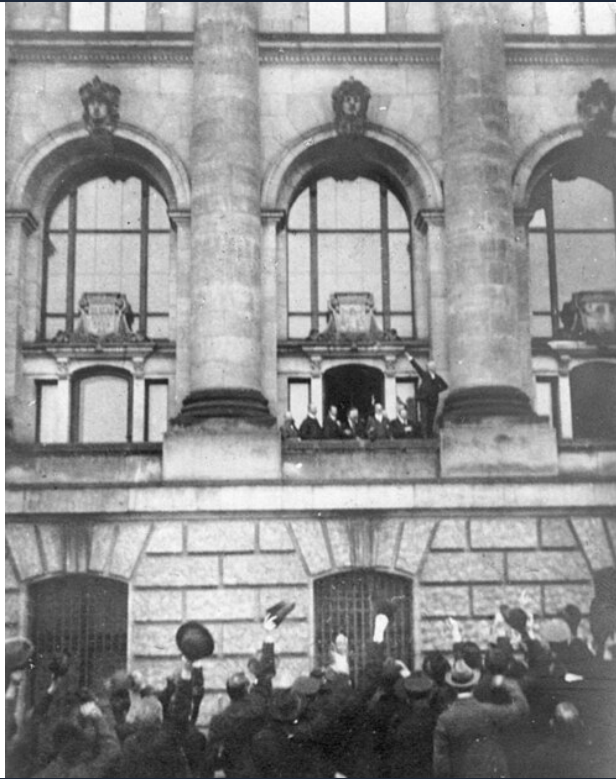




THE HISTORY PORTAL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

FROM DEMOCRACY TO DICTATORSHIP: HOW DID HITLER DESTROY THE WEIMAR REPUBLIC?

*Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918-39 - Key
Topic 1: The Weimar Republic*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT1.1: The Origins of the Republic, 1918–1919 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST (Q1 INFERENCE)			
L2: KT1.2: Early Challenges to the Republic, 1919–1923 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q2 CAUSATION)			
L3: KT1.3: The Recovery of the Republic, 1924–1929 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q2) / JUNE 2026 SPECIMEN (Q3A)			
L4: KT1.4: Changes in Society, 1924–1929 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q3B-D INTERPRETATIONS)			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT1.1: The Origins of the Republic, 1918–1919

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge of the catastrophic social, economic, and political situation in Germany at the end of the First World War.
- ☐ Analyse the chronological sequence of events that led to the abdication of Kaiser Wilhelm II, the signing of the Armistice, and the birth of the Republic.
- ☐ Evaluate the democratic strengths and structural weaknesses of the new Weimar Constitution, judging the extent to which it left the Republic vulnerable to instability.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the Triple Entente in the First World War?

What was the Triple Alliance?

What is a 'dictatorship'?

What is a 'democracy'?

What does 'abdicate' mean?

What is a 'republic'?

What does 'inflation' mean?

What is an 'armistice'?

What does 'mutiny' mean?

In what year did the First World War begin?

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?

Reichstag | Reichsrat | Armistice | Constitution | Dolchstoßlegende | November Criminals | Proportional Representation (PR) | Coalition Government | Article 48

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was the Weimar Republic doomed from the start?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Causal Linkage

Q2. Write a short paragraph explaining how the conditions described in Source C directly led to the events in Source D.

Constrained Summary

Q3. Summarize the potential danger of Source E (Article 48) in exactly 12 words.

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q4. Complete these three sentences with historically accurate details: 1) Proportional Representation was highly democratic, BUT... 2) Philipp Scheidemann rushed to declare a Republic BECAUSE... 3) The army felt betrayed by the Armistice, SO...

Causal Linkage

Q5. Write a short paragraph explaining exactly how the British Naval Blockade eventually led to the Abdication of the Kaiser. You must explain the chain reaction of events (the 'domino effect') that connects them.

Transforming Information

Q6. Imagine you are an advisor to President Ebert in 1919. Write a short, urgent memo to him explaining which specific weakness of the new Constitution (Article 48, Proportional Representation, or Coalitions) poses the greatest threat to the Republic, and why.

Vocabulary in Context

Q7. Write a 4-sentence summary of the birth of the Weimar Republic. You must use all five of these keywords correctly: Autocracy, Dolchstoßlegende, November Criminals, Armistice, Reichstag.

The 'Diamond Ranking' Challenge

Q8. You have been given four reasons why the Weimar Republic was highly unstable in 1919:

- 1. The legacy of the First World War**
- 2. The 'Stab-in-the-back' myth**
- 3. Proportional Representation**
- 4. Article 48**

Rank these four causes in order of importance. Write a persuasive, open-ended paragraph justifying your #1 choice over your #2 choice.

Level 9 Challenge: *In your paragraph, use complex causal reasoning to explicitly explain how your #1 cause directly triggered or worsened your #2 cause.*

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A: From a speech by Philipp Scheidemann, announcing the new Republic from the balcony of the Reichstag, 9 November 1918.

"Workers and soldiers! The German people have won all along the line! The old and rotten monarchy has collapsed. Long live the new German Republic!"

Q9. 1. Give two things you can infer from Source A about the establishment of the Weimar Republic in November 1918.

(i) What I can infer:
Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:
Details in the source that tell me this: ★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST (Q1 INFERENCE)

[4 marks • 5 mins]

General Notes

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L2: KT1.2: Early Challenges to the Republic, 1919–1923

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge of the Treaty of Versailles and explain why it made the Republic instantly unpopular.
- ☐ Analyse the political challenges from the extreme Left (the Spartacist Uprising) and the extreme Right (the Kapp Putsch), evaluating why the Republic struggled to maintain authority.
- ☐ Evaluate the causes and devastating social and economic consequences of the 1923 Ruhr crisis and hyperinflation, identifying the 'winners' and 'losers' of the economic collapse.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

When did the First World War end?

Who was the Kaiser of Germany during WW1?

Why did the Kaiser abdicate?

What was the 'stab in the back' myth (Dolchstoßlegende)?

Who were the 'November Criminals'?

What is a 'democracy'?

What is a 'republic'?

What does 'mutiny' mean?

What was the Triple Entente?

What does 'abdicate' mean?

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

Diktat | Reparations | Spartacist League | Freikorps | Putsch | Passive Resistance | Hyperinflation

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Which was the greater threat to the Republic: the extreme Left (Spartacists) or the extreme Right (Kapp)?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson's narrative, explaining the cause-and-effect relationships:

- 1. The Treaty of Versailles was deeply unpopular in Germany, BUT...**
- 2. The Weimar Republic faced numerous challenges from both the left and the right BECAUSE...**
- 3. The Ruhr Crisis and the policy of Passive Resistance led to Hyperinflation, SO...**

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (3-5 sentences) explaining the interconnectedness of the terms: *Diktat*, *Reparations*, *Passive Resistance*, and *Hyperinflation* in the context of the Weimar Republic's early challenges.

Prioritising Causes

Q4. Of the challenges discussed in the lesson (Treaty of Versailles/Reparations, political uprisings like the Spartacist Uprising and Kapp Putsch, and the Ruhr Crisis/Hyperinflation), which do you think was the *most* damaging to the Weimar Republic's stability between 1919-1923 and why? Justify your choice with specific details.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine the Weimar Republic had successfully negotiated a significantly reduced reparations payment in 1920, avoiding the Ruhr Crisis and subsequent Hyperinflation. How might the political landscape of Germany have evolved differently by 1923, particularly concerning the rise of extremist groups like the Nazi Party?

GCSE Exam Practice

Q6. 2. Explain why the Treaty of Versailles caused significant challenges for the Weimar Republic in the years 1919-1923 .

You may use the following in your answer:

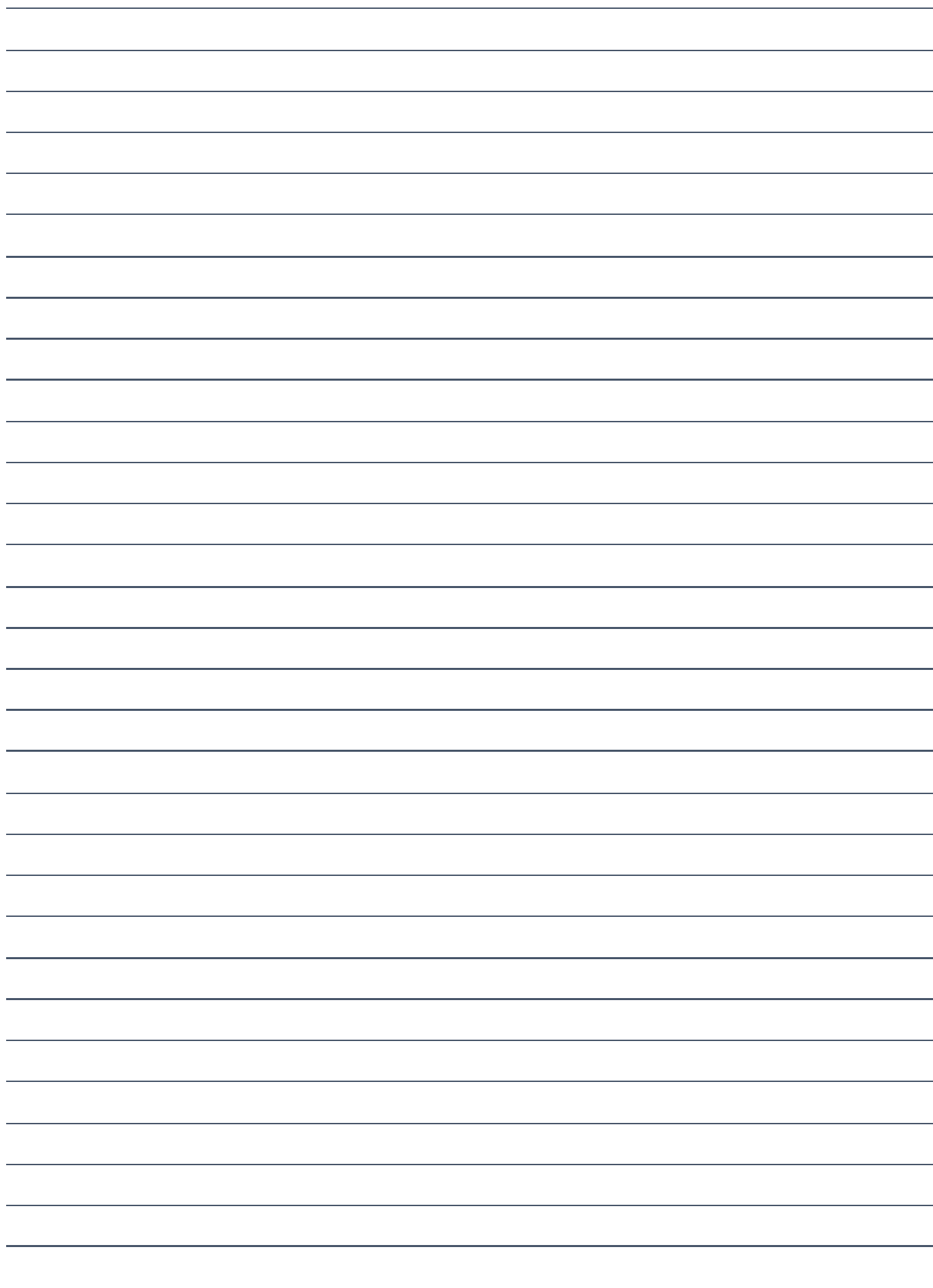
- **Reparations**
- **The 'stab-in-the-back' myth**

You must also use information of your own.

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q2 CAUSATION)

[12 marks • 15 mins]

[illegible]



General Notes

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L3: KT1.3: The Recovery of the Republic, 1924–1929

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge of Stresemann's economic strategies, including the Rentenmark, the Dawes Plan, and the Young Plan.
- ☐ Analyse Stresemann's foreign policy achievements (the Locarno Pact, joining the League of Nations, the Kellogg-Briand Pact) and explain how they restored German pride.
- ☐ Evaluate the extent of German recovery by 1929, distinguishing between genuine political stability and superficial economic prosperity.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the Weimar Constitution?

What was Proportional Representation (PR)?

Why was Proportional Representation a weakness?

What was Article 48?

Who was the first President of the Weimar Republic?

What was the 'stab in the back' myth?

Who were the 'November Criminals'?

When did WW1 end?

What is an 'armistice'?

What does 'inflation' mean?

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:

Rentenmark Reichsmark Dawes Plan (1924) Young Plan (1929) Locarno Pact (1925) League of Nations Kellogg-Briand Pact (1928)	
Power, Governance & Warfare	Economy, Trade & Society

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was Stresemann's recovery a true Golden Age or just a mirage?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson: 1) Germany's economy experienced a period of recovery and stability between 1924 and 1929, BUT... 2) Gustav Stresemann was a pivotal figure in Germany's recovery BECAUSE... 3) Germany regained significant international standing SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using at least three of the keywords (Rentenmark, Reichsmark, Dawes Plan, Young Plan, Locarno Pact, League of Nations, Kellogg-Briand Pact), write a short paragraph

explaining how Germany achieved both economic stability and improved international relations during the 'Golden Twenties'.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the causal link between Germany's economic recovery and its ability to achieve foreign policy successes between 1924 and 1929. How did one directly enable the other?

Complex Causal Reasoning

Q5. To what extent was Germany's 'recovery' between 1924 and 1929 a genuine and sustainable improvement, or was it built on fragile foundations? Argue both sides, considering the interconnectedness of economic, political, and foreign policy factors.

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):
From a private letter written by Gustav Stresemann, September 1928.

Our economic recovery is only flourishing on the surface. Germany is, in fact, dancing on a volcano. If our American creditors should ever decide to call in their short-term loans, a very large section of our industrial and commercial economy will collapse immediately.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source):
From an article in a German financial newspaper, late 1928.

Our national economy has finally achieved genuine stability. Through the Dawes Plan and massive American investment, our factories have been modernized with advanced assembly-line techniques, causing industrial production to soar. Support for extremist parties like the Nazis has collapsed, proving that our citizens are contented and that the Weimar Republic is finally safe.

Q6. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into Stresemann's Recovery?

EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q2) / JUNE 2026 SPECIMEN (Q3A)

[8 marks • 10 mins]

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General Notes

[illegible]

L4: KT1.4: Changes in Society, 1924–1929

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge of changes in the standard of living, including wages, housing, and unemployment insurance.
- ☐ Analyse the changing position of women in politics, work, and leisure, contrasting the reality of their lives with the image of the 'New Woman'.
- ☐ Evaluate the explosion of cultural changes in art, cinema, and architecture, judging why this provoked such fierce opposition from traditionalists and extremists.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Which treaty punished Germany after WW1?

How much was Germany forced to pay in reparations?

What was Article 231?

How was the German army restricted by the Treaty?

What happened to the Rhineland?

What was Proportional Representation?

What was Article 48?

Who were the November Criminals?

Who was Friedrich Ebert?

What is a 'dictatorship'?

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:

Standard of Living | Unemployment Insurance Act (1927) | New Woman (Neue Frau) | Article 109 |
Avant-garde | New Objectivity (Neue Sachlichkeit) | Bauhaus

"Under Article 109 of the Weimar Constitution, the German government outlawed the New Woman and banned all Bauhaus architecture to prevent improvements in the Standard of Living."

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did the changes in society (1924-1929) benefit all Germans equally?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the provided text: 1) The standard of living generally improved in Germany between 1924-1929 BUT... 2) The 'New Woman' became a prominent figure in Weimar society BECAUSE... 3) Weimar culture saw an explosion of avant-garde movements SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using at least FOUR of the provided keywords (Standard of Living, Unemployment Insurance Act (1927), New Woman (Neue Frau), Article 109, Avant-garde, New Objectivity (Neue Sachlichkeit), Bauhaus), write a short paragraph (approx. 70-100 words) explaining how society changed in Weimar Germany between 1924 and 1929.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the causal links between Germany's economic stability (1924-1929), the emergence of the 'New Woman', and the flourishing of avant-garde culture. How did these three elements influence each other?

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine the 'Golden Age' of Weimar Germany (1924-1929) never happened, and instead, economic instability and high unemployment persisted throughout the decade. How might the development of the 'New Woman' and the flourishing of avant-garde culture have been significantly different, or even stifled? Provide specific reasons and examples.

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Interpretation 1 (The Social Liberation View):

The Weimar era brought a profound, lasting social and political liberation for German women. The introduction of female suffrage in 1918 resulted in high female representation in the Reichstag, while economic recovery opened up millions of new white-collar job opportunities. This allowed a new generation of independent, financially self-sufficient women to confidently challenge traditional gender roles.

Interpretation 2 (The Traditionalist Backlash View):

The concept of the liberated 'New Woman' was an urban myth that did not reflect the reality for the vast majority of German women. Most women remained trapped in low-paid, unskilled agricultural and domestic work, and the constitution's promises of equality were rarely enforced in the workplace. The visible changes in Berlin cabaret culture actually provoked a massive, hostile traditionalist backlash that weakened the Republic.

Q6. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about Weimar Women. What is the main difference between these views?

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q3B INTERPRETATION DIFFERENCE)

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q7. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about Weimar Women. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q3C INTERPRETATION WHY)

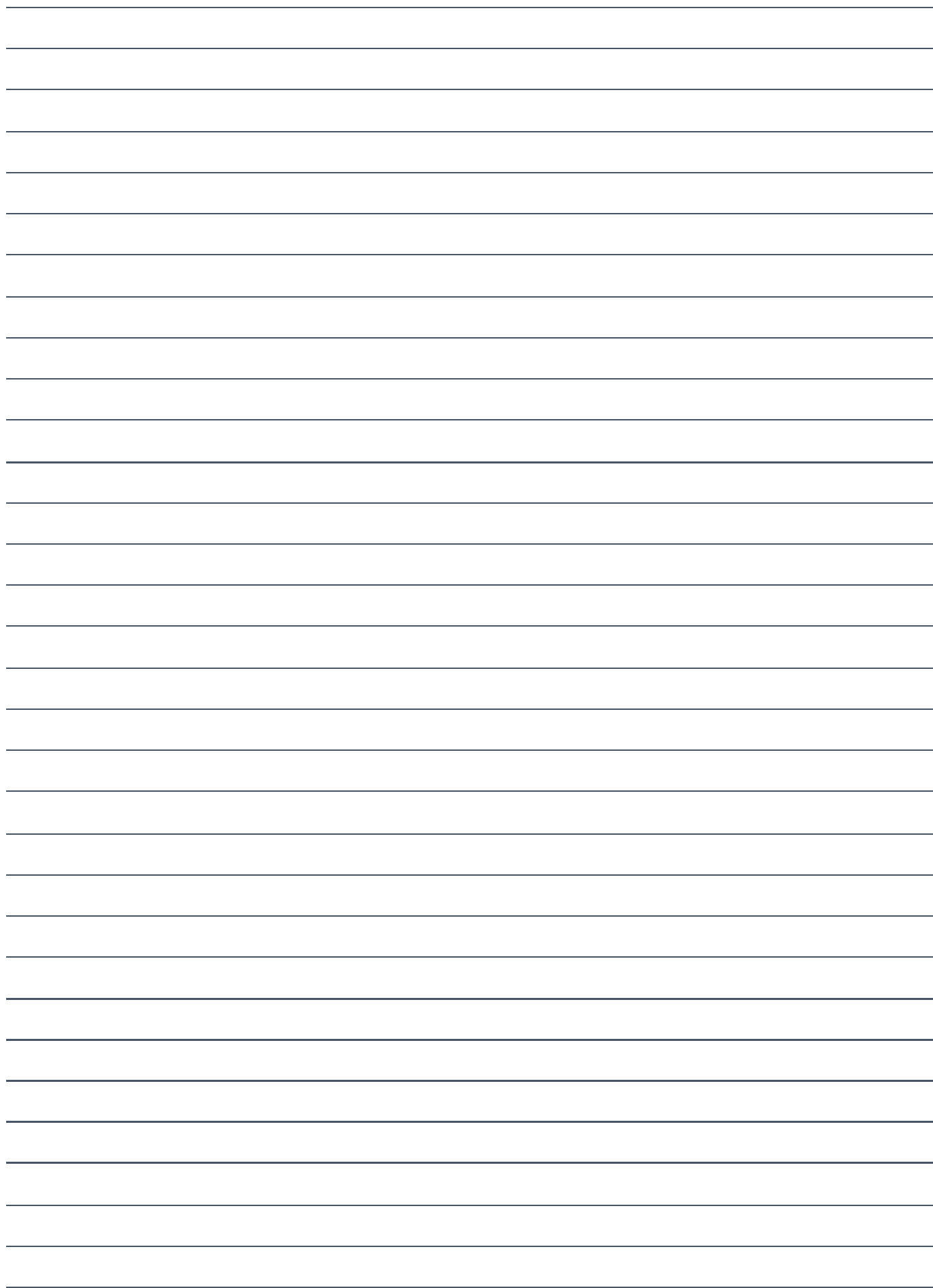
[4 marks • 5 mins]

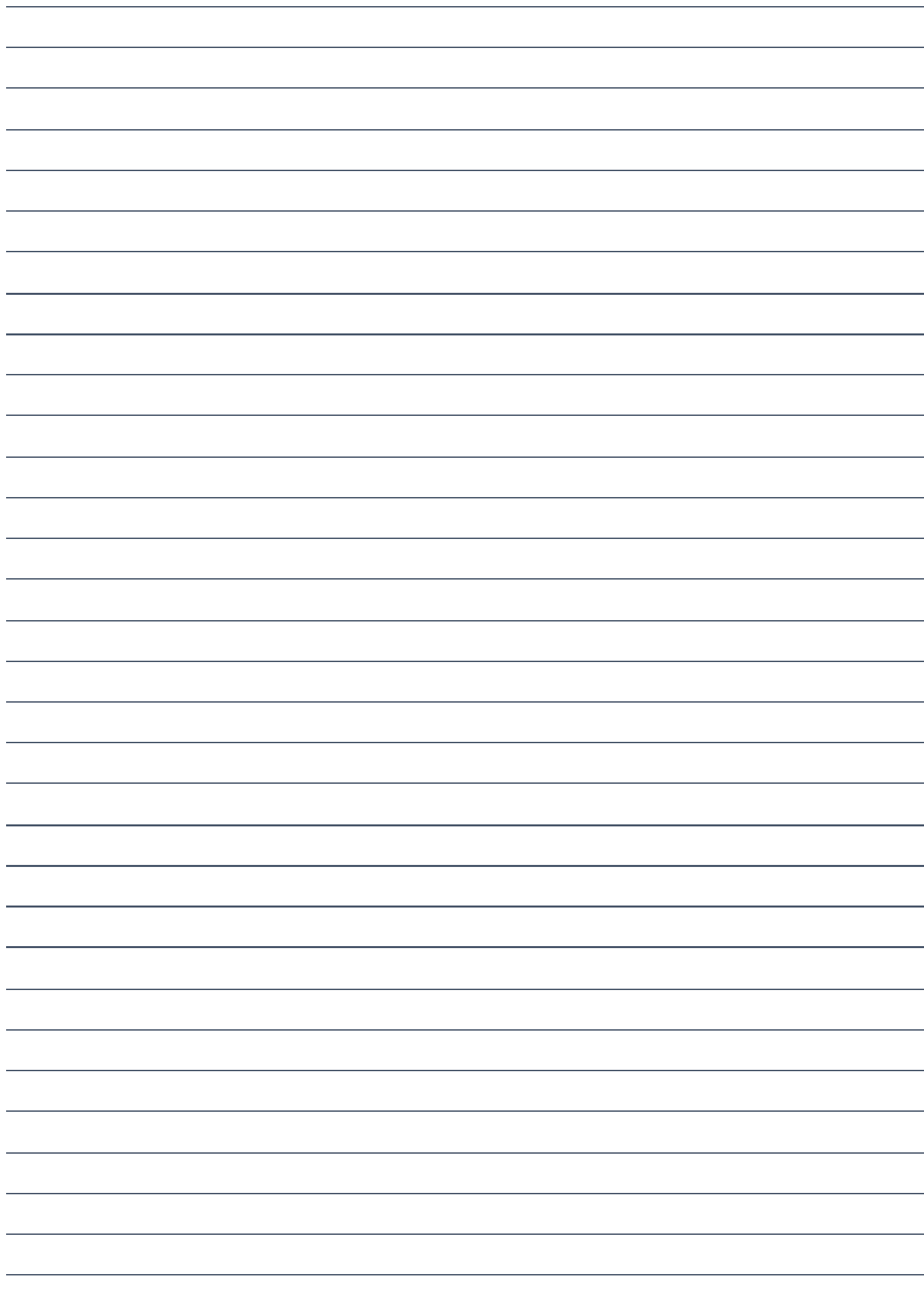
Q8. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about Weimar Women? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q3D INTERPRETATION EVALUATION)

[16 marks • 20 mins]

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TEACHER FEEDBACK & D.I.R.T.

Mark: _____ / 16 (+4 SPaG) | Effort: 1 2 3 4 5

SPaG Self/Peer Checklist (4 Marks):

☐ Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. Reichstag, Ebert)

☐ Historical terminology spelled accurately

☐ Punctuation separates complex clauses

What Went Well (WWW):

.....
.....

Even Better If (EBI):

.....
.....

Student D.I.R.T. Response / Correction:

.....
.....

[illegible]

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 3: Weimar & Nazi Germany (1918–39)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)